Krishnaswamy Rao Sahib, Home Secretary T.N. Chaturvedi and Special Secretary, Home, P.P. Nayyar, were also present. Swaran Singh also attended the meeting. His plea was that the Akalis should be given a way out to withdraw their agitation before their planned meeting on 4 November. That could be done by making a conciliatory announcement on the basis of what had been agreed with the Akali leaders on 2 November. It was decided that Home Minister P.C. Sethi would make a statement in parliament on the morning of 4 November on the government's stand on the Akali demands, and a copy of it would thereafter be passed on to the Akali Dal leadership at Amritsar. It appeared at that point that everybody involved was satisfied with the outcome of the meetings on 2 and 3 November.

Swaran Singh and the cabinet committee met once again in the afternoon on 3 November. A draft statement, which was to be made in parliament the next morning, was prepared. The gist of the statement, as I learnt from my father-in-law some time later, is given below:

1. All religious demands were to be fully met.
2. Regarding devolution of some Central powers to Punjab as envisaged in the Anandpur Sahib Resolution, a commission would be appointed to go into the entire gamut of Centre–state relations, and make recommendations about which powers could be transferred to the states.
3. Regarding sharing of river waters, efforts would be made to suitably compensate Punjab for the loss of water resulting from agreement signed 31 December 1981.
4. About Chandigarh, efforts would be made to compensate Haryana, financially and otherwise, in lieu of Haryana not insisting on the transfer of Fazilka and Abohar areas as a condition for the transfer of Chandigarh to Punjab.
5. Finally, a brief mention was made of the role of the Sikhs in the freedom movement and the contribution made by them after independence.